In collaboration with the Ministry of New and Renewable Energy and Tata Power Skill Development Institute (TPSDI), the Ministry has launched training programmes in Solar PV Helper and Assistant Technician skills for ST and PVTG youth. Training has already been conducted in Odisha, Uttar Pradesh, Jharkhand and Kerala, with additional States being added in the next phase.

The Ministry is also promoting tribal homestays through the Tribal Eco Tourism Pilot Programme (TEEP) in partnership with the India Tourism Development Corporation (ITDC). The initiative equips tribal families with hospitality, guest management and tourism skills, enabling them to generate sustainable income while showcasing their unique culture, traditions and natural heritage. Homestay owners from Arunachal Pradesh, Sikkim and Gujarat have already been trained, with the programme set to expand to more tribal regions across the country.

Recognising excellence in tribal tourism, the Ministry partnered with the India Today Tourism Awards and Survey 2026, where Nawang Chotta Homestay of Arunachal Pradesh received the Best Homestay Award. The recognition reflects the growing potential of tribal tourism as a vehicle for livelihood generation, cultural preservation and responsible travel.

Strengthening health care

Ministry is strengthening tribal healthcare through the JANHIT (Janjatiya Health Intelligence and Technology) initiative; a comprehensive platform for improving disease surveillance, preventive healthcare, traditional medicine integration and evidence-based policy making in tribal areas. The initiative aims to integrate community-level health data with programme implementation, enabling timely interventions, targeted planning and improved health outcomes for tribal communities.

Ministry has entered into a strategic collaboration with ICMR–National Institute of Health Research (ICMR-NIHR) to scientifically strengthen community-based healthcare systems in tribal areas while



recognising the invaluable role of traditional tribal healers. The collaboration also includes establishment of Central and Regional Programme Management Units, orientation of State Tribal Welfare and Health Departments, and implementation of the Bharat Tribal Family Health Survey, Sentinel Surveillance and Disease Elimination programmes. This partnership represents a unique convergence of traditional tribal knowledge and modern public health systems to improve healthcare accessibility, strengthen disease prevention and preserve India's rich indigenous medical heritage.

Ministry is partnering with Council of Scientific and Industrial Research - National Botanical Research Institute (CSIR-NBRI) for conservation of medicinal plants and rare, endangered and threatened species. The programme includes bio-resource conservation programme, ethnobotanical surveys, capacity building of tribal youth and healers, establishment of scientific conservation and propagation systems for medicinal plant resources.

Ministry has launched a national challenge for preparation of high-quality district proposals covering agriculture; fisheries; animal husbandry; NTFP value chains; women's SHGs; skill-based enterprises. Selected proposals will receive financial assistance for implementation of projects which will culminate in development of Agri-based clusters. This initiative aims to generate sustainable livelihoods and strengthen value chains in tribal districts.

Tribal Freedom Fighter Model Village (TFFMV) Initiative envisions to develop the birthplace villages of revered tribal freedom fighters into model villages that reflect tribal heritage, dignity and holistic development. Eleven priority villages have been shortlisted across 10 States and 1 Union Territory, each linked to a tribal freedom fighter.

Ministry is focussing on setting up of community managed crèches to provide services like day care for PVTG / tribal children of age 06 months to 3 years, provision of meals, growth monitoring, routine immunization and health check-ups to tackle the challenges presented in form of malnutrition and high burden on tribal women owing to geographical remoteness of PVTG/tribal habitations.

Janjatiya Garima Utsav 2026: Celebrating the Journey of Tribal Transformation

Building upon these initiatives, the Ministry organised Janjatiya Garima Utsav 2026 from 10 May to 9 June 2026 as a month-long celebration of tribal dignity, opportunity, participation and achievement. The Utsav was structured around four thematic components: Technology as a Development Driver, highlighting the role of technology, AI and digital innovation in tribal education, healthcare, livelihoods and service delivery; Jan Bhagidari Abhiyan : Sabse Door, Sabse Pehle, focusing on saturation of services, health outreach, livelihood support and direct engagement with communities in the most remote tribal habitations; Birsa Lives in New Bharat, celebrating tribal heritage, the legacy of Bhagwan Birsa Munda and the achievements of contemporary tribal leaders and changemakers; and From Classroom to Confidence, showcasing the impact of EMRS, scholarships and institutional support in enabling tribal youth to emerge as skilled, confident and aspirational participants in India's development journey. The Utsav culminated bringing together these interventions under a unified narrative of tribal pride, empowerment and inclusive development.

